a FlexLifeFi K–12 program

GRADE 7 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

Workbook for the Year

Activities, sort tasks, and reflection prompts you'll keep.

Year theme: Know Your Customer

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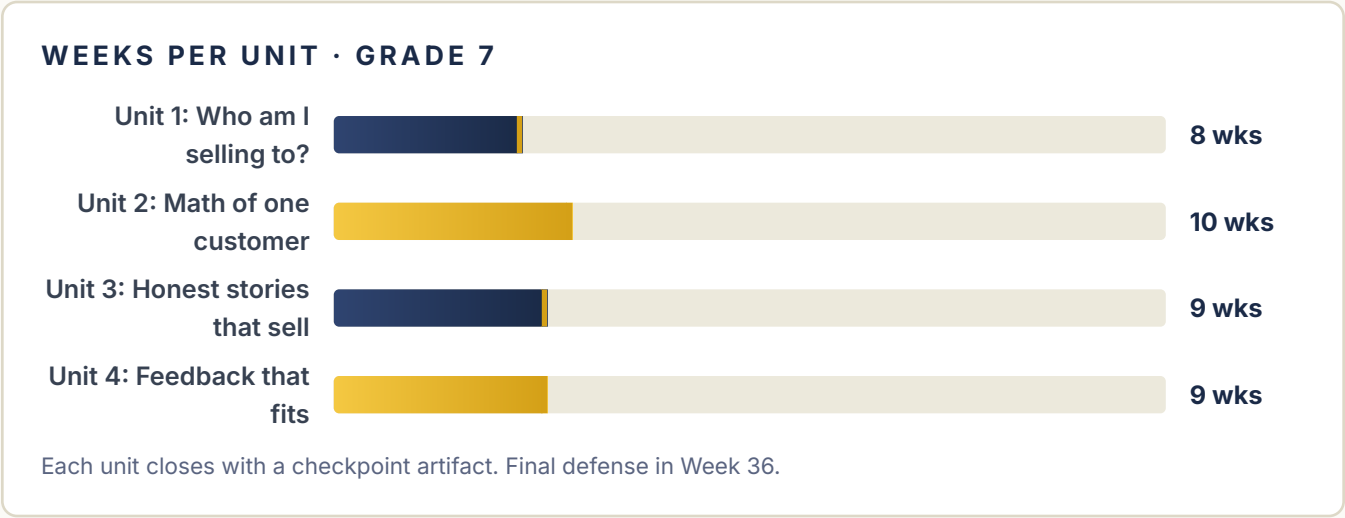
YEAR-AT-A-GLANCE

Four Units. Thirty-Six Weeks. One Capstone.

The year is built as four units, each ending with a public-facing artifact that feeds the rolling Capstone. The bars show how the weeks are spent — roughly equal, with a slight lean toward the math-heavy unit because per-customer math is the load-bearing skill.



36 WEEKS

4 UNITS

10 LESSONS

8 CASH VIDEOS

GRADE 7 · STUDENT ACTIVITY BOOK

Workbook for the Year

Customers are evidence, not assumptions.

Welcome.

This is your activity book for the year. It's the place to do the work that turns big ideas into real things you've made. You'll fill it in, mess it up, scratch things out, and revise. That's the point.

Cash, your animated guide for the year, will pop up between sections to ask the questions that matter. Cash never tells you what to do — Cash asks what your evidence says. Get used to the question: **which people, and how do you know?**

This book mirrors the four units. Each unit has activities, projects, and reflection prompts. You'll also keep a Capstone Journal in a separate notebook — the place where you sketch, plan, and reflect. This book is the structured part. The journal is the messy part. You need both.

How to use this book

"Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal."

— CASH

- **Date every entry.** Future-you will care.
- **Quote your evidence.** When you write what a customer said, use their actual words. Made-up quotes are not evidence; they're imagination dressed up as fact.
- **Don't skip the reflection prompts.** They look optional. They are not.
- **It's okay to be wrong.** The point of evidence is to find out where you were wrong, fast.

Unit 1 — Who am I selling to?

"Tell me what they actually said."

— CASH

Activity 1.1 — Day 1 Customer Assumption

Fill in this sentence about your imagined customer:

"I think my customer is _____ who wants _____ because _____."

One thing I'm least sure about in this assumption:

Predict: In Week 8, how wrong will this be? Circle one.

1	2	3	4	5
Totally right	Mostly right	Half right	Mostly wrong	Completely wrong

Activity 1.2 — Skills + Hobbies + Needs Web

Fill each section with at least 3 entries. Don't overthink it — write fast, edit later.

Skills I have or could build: 1. _____ **2.** _____ 3. _____

Hobbies I actually do: 1. _____ **2.** _____ 3. _____

Needs I see (problems people I know complain about): 1. _____ **2.** _____ 3. _____

Two business ideas this web suggests:

A. _____

B. _____

Activity 1.3 — Demographic vs. Behavioral

Sort the following customer descriptions into Demographic (D) or Behavioral (B). Put a D or B in front of each.

___ 12 years old ___ Plays soccer Tuesday and Thursday after school ___ Lives in a small town ___ Always forgets to charge her phone overnight ___ Female ___ Saves half her allowance ___ Hispanic / Latina ___ Texts more than calls ___ Eighth-grade student ___ Skips breakfast on game days

Reflection (2–3 sentences): Which kind tells you more about how a customer actually behaves? Why might a business need both?

Activity 1.4 — Interview Script Builder

Write 7 questions you'll use in your customer interviews. Mix open and closed; no leading.

#	Question	Open / Closed
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

Self-check: Read each question to a partner. If your partner can answer it the way you'd want without thinking, it's probably leading. Rewrite.

Activity 1.5 — Interview Transcript Page (Use 3 Pages, One per Interview)

Date:	**Interview #:**
Interviewee initials only:	Their relationship to me:

Their actual words (no paraphrasing):

Q1: _____ **A:** _____

Q2: _____ **A:** _____

(Continue. Yes, write what they said, not what you wished they said.)

One thing that surprised me in this interview:

Activity 1.6 — Three-Color Coding (Use After All 3 Interviews)

After re-reading all three transcripts with highlighters:

Yellow (problem/frustration) tally:

Frustration	Said by # of interviewees

Blue (workaround) tally:

Workaround	Said by # of interviewees

Pink (surprise): What surprised you most across all three?

Activity 1.7 — Persona One-Pager (Goes on the Wall)

One-line summary:

Demographic:

- Age: _ **Grade:** _ Setting: _____

Daily routine (a typical Tuesday):

Top 3 frustrations (each with a quote from a real interview):

1. _____ — "_____"
2. _____ — "_____"
3. _____ — "_____"

Where to reach them (3 channels):

A. _____ **B.** _____ C. _____

Activity 1.8 — Problem Statement

Write your problem statement using this exact form:

"_____ **struggles with** _____ when _____**, because** _____."

Activity 1.9 — What Changed Since Day 1

(Open Day 1 Assumption card. Read it. Then write below.)

On Day 1, I assumed my customer was...

After interviews, I now think my customer is...

The biggest evidence-based change was...

...because...

Unit 1 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal, answer:

1. What was the most surprising thing a customer said?
2. What's a question I wish I had asked but didn't?
3. What does my customer need that nobody is giving them yet?

Unit 2 — Math of one customer

"A little less wrong, every week."

— CASH

Activity 2.1 — Variable Cost Calculator

Use a real or imagined receipt. Compute variable cost per customer step by step.

Item	Pack price	Items per pack	Cost per item	Items used per customer	Cost per customer
	Total variable cost per customer:				$

Activity 2.2 — Variable vs. Fixed Sort

For each item below, write V (variable) or F (fixed):

___ Box of 50 stickers ___ Yearly Etsy fee ___ Custom logo design (one-time) ___ Cardstock for thank-you notes (one per customer) ___ Domain name fee ($15/year) ___ Per-customer ad spend ___ Photo backdrop (used for all your product photos) ___ Shipping box (one per shipment)

Activity 2.3 — Lemonade Stand Lab

	Stand A	Stand B
Price per cup	$2.00	$1.00
Variable cost per cup	$1.80	$0.30
Cups sold	50	30
Revenue	$___	$___
Contribution per cup	$___	$___
Total contribution	$___	$___

Which stand has more revenue? _ Which stand has more contribution? _ Which stand is in a better spot to grow? Why?

Activity 2.4 — Your Capstone's Contribution Margin

Your product/service: ___

- Price per unit: $_____
- Variable cost per unit (from 2.1): $_____
- **Contribution margin per unit:** $_____
- Estimated units per month: _____
- **Total monthly contribution:** $_____
- One example fixed cost per month: **__ ($___**)
- **Estimated monthly profit:** $_____

What if your price went up 10%? CM becomes: $__ What if your variable cost went down 10%? CM becomes: $_ Which 10% change made a bigger profit difference? ___

Activity 2.5 — Pricing Tradeoffs

Test three prices for your Capstone. Estimate units sold at each (your best guess based on what you've heard from customers).

Price	Units sold	Revenue	VC per unit	CM per unit	Total CM

Recommended price: $_____ **Why:**

Activity 2.6 — Pricing Memo

Write a 1-page memo using this structure:

To: Cash (and your future self) **From:** [Your name] **Date:** _____ **Subject:** Pricing recommendation for [your venture]

1. **What I'm pricing.** (1–2 sentences.)
2. **My recommended price.** (1 sentence.)
3. **Why this price.** (3–5 sentences. Cite contribution margin numbers.)
4. **What would have to be true for me to be wrong.** (2–3 sentences.)

(Use the Capstone Journal for this — write the full memo.)

Unit 2 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. Did doing the math change my mind about my Capstone?
2. Where am I least sure about my numbers?
3. If I had to cut my variable cost by 20%, where would I cut?

Unit 3 — Honest stories that sell

"Honest claims build customers who come back. Tricks build customers who feel taken."

— CASH

Activity 3.1 — Persuasion Spotter

For each ad you analyze, mark which technique it uses (mark all that apply):

Ad #	Scarcity	Social Proof	Authority	Urgency	Fear	Other?
1						
2						
3						
4						
5						

For Ad #3, write 1–2 sentences: is the technique used honestly or manipulatively? Why?

Activity 3.2 — Fair-to-Customer Check on a Real Product

Pick a real product page (your choice). Apply the four points:

	Pass / Fail / Borderline	Why
Clear claim		
Honest price		
Real reviews		
Easy returns		

Verdict: Persuasion / Manipulation / Borderline. Reasoning:

Activity 3.3 — Your Capstone Pledge

In my Capstone, I will not _____ because _____.

In my Capstone, I will _____ because _____.

If a friend told me to "stretch the truth a little" to sell more, I would _____ _____.

Activity 3.4 — Build Your Two A/B Test Messages

Same product, two messages, same length, only the words change.

Message A (your hypothesis: this will win because...):

Message B (your hypothesis: this might win because...):

My prediction: _ will win because _____ _____.

One bias my test cannot eliminate: _____ _____.

Activity 3.5 — A/B Test Results

Day	Message A votes	Message B votes
1		
2		
3		
Total		

Winner: __ Margin (winner – loser): __

One thing I cannot tell from this test:

My final message after the test:

Activity 3.6 — Messaging Memo

Write a 1-page memo (in the Capstone Journal):

1. **What I tested.**
2. **What I found.**
3. **What I'm changing.**
4. **What I'd test next.**

Unit 3 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. Was I tempted to "stretch the truth" anywhere? Where?
2. What does it feel like to win or lose an A/B test?
3. If a customer said "your message is misleading," what would I do?

Unit 4 — Feedback that fits

Activity 4.1 — Survey Designer

Write your 3-question survey for your Capstone customers.

Q1 (open question, gets a story):

Q2 (closed question, gets a number or scale):

Q3 (the magic one — would you recommend? why or why not?):

Channel + cadence: Where will you ask? When? How often?

Activity 4.2 — Signal/Noise Sort

After collecting your survey responses, sort each into one of three columns:

Signal (theme + actionable)	Borderline	Noise

Activity 4.3 — One Change, Defended

The strongest signal in my feedback was:

Because of this, I'm changing:

Here's how I'll know if the change worked:

Activity 4.4 — Change Report

After making the change:

What I changed:	What happened next:

Did the change work? How do I know?

One quiet signal I'm watching for next:

Unit 4 Reflection

In your Capstone Journal:

1. What was the hardest piece of feedback to hear?
2. What was the most useful?
3. If I were running this venture for real, how often would I run a survey?

Capstone Defense Prep

Activity 5.1 — The Five-Minute Defense Outline

You have 5 minutes. Plan it out, one minute per section.

Minute 1: The customer. Who, exactly, did I learn this is for? (1 quote.) - _____

Minute 2: The math. What does each customer contribute, and how did I price it? - _____

Minute 3: The message. What did I test, and what won? - _____

Minute 4: The change. What did feedback teach me to change, and what happened?
- _____

Minute 5: What I learned about myself. - _____

Activity 5.2 — Year-End Reflection

The biggest thing I learned this year was:

One thing I'd tell next year's Grade 7 student:

I'm proud of:

I'm going to keep working on:

A short note from Cash

Hey — Cash here.

You didn't make a million dollars this year. You probably didn't even sell anything. That's okay. What you did was harder and more useful: you learned to ask "which people, and how do you know?" before you spent a single dollar building. Most adults skip that part. You won't.

When you start a real venture someday, the muscles you built this year — listening to a customer, doing the math, telling the truth in your message, listening for signal — those are the muscles that matter. Keep using them. See you in Grade 8.

ABOUT THE HOST

Cash, in five words

curious · warm · honest · patient · specific

"I'm Cash. I don't promise wealth. I don't promise success. I promise that the moves — interview, math, message, listen — will make you a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."

— CASH

What Cash does

- **Asks questions that point to evidence.** Cash never tells; Cash asks what your evidence says.
- **Names rules sparingly.** "An assumption is something you think is true without checking. Evidence is something you observed, heard, or counted."
- **Tells short, made-up-but-realistic stories.** 30–60 seconds, shows don't tell.
- **Celebrates the move, not the win.** Revision, honesty, and evidence — not revenue.
- **Hedges deliberately.** probably, often, sometimes — never absolutes about complex topics.

What Cash never does

- Flatter ("amazing!", "great job!"), promise wealth, moralize about money.
- Reference real brands or living celebrities as endorsements.
- Surface family financial details. (Hypothetical scenarios only.)
- Pretend the world is fair. Cash is honest about systemic factors without becoming a politics class.

> *When in doubt, work one of these into the script: Which people, and how do you know? · Being wrong on Day 1 is the deal. · Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. · A little less wrong, every week.*

STRAND OUTCOMES

Eight Strands. One Year. Verifiable Outcomes.

Cash to Company runs the same eight strands K-12. Each year deepens the demonstration. The Grade 7 version of each strand is below.

Code	Strand	Grade 7 demonstrated outcome
BAVC	Business Awareness and Value Creation	Identify a business problem, propose a value-creation hypothesis, and revise it with customer evidence.
PSIG	Problem Solving and Idea Generation	Generate, screen, and refine ideas; document why one was chosen and the others were not.
MFL	Money and Financial Literacy	Compute revenue, variable cost, contribution margin, and breakeven for a real product or service.
CBM	Customers, Branding, Marketing	Build a persona from interview evidence; design honest messaging; A/B test two claims.
OSO	Operations, Systems, Organization	Design a simple weekly operating cadence with named roles, handoffs, and a feedback loop.
LTO	Leadership, Teamwork, Ownership	Run and document a team meeting; resolve one disagreement using shared evidence.
ESL	Ethics, Safety, Legal Awareness	Identify the line between persuasion and manipulation; flag one borderline claim and rewrite it honestly.
LRCI	Launch Readiness and Continuous Improvement	Pilot, measure, and document at least three iterations with rationale and what changed.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

Six Benchmarks This Year

Standards are cited at the benchmark level. Honest gaps are named when they exist.
The Capstone artifact addresses each one.

Benchmark	What students must demonstrate
Jump$tart 6 (Financial Decision Making) 8-2	Identify ways consumers may avoid making poor decisions; apply to entrepreneurs avoiding poor customer guesses.
CCSS-ELA W.7.4	Produce clear and coherent writing in which the development, organization, and style are appropriate to task.
CCSS-ELA SL.7.1	Engage effectively in a range of collaborative discussions.
CASEL Social Awareness	Recognize the perspectives of others; demonstrate empathy.
C3 D2.Eco.1.6-8	Explain how economic decisions affect well-being of individuals, businesses, society.
Jump$tart 1 (Spending & Saving) 8-2	Demonstrate ability to use number skills to manage money.

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE

Each lesson cites at least one of these benchmarks. Each Capstone checkpoint addresses two or more. The Teacher Guide includes a per-lesson standards crosswalk.

"Standards aren't a cage. They're a list of moves you're going to be glad you can make. Pick one. Practice it. Move on."

— CASH

CAPSTONE RUBRIC (4-POINT)

How We Score the Capstone

The Capstone artifact is scored on four traits, each on a 4-point scale. Honest, specific, decision-oriented work earns the high marks. Generic or assumption-laden work earns the low ones.

Trait	1 — Emerging	2 — Developing	3 — Proficient	4 — Advanced
Evidence quality	Mostly assumptions; few or no quotes.	2-3 interview quotes; partial evidence.	5+ direct quotes; varied sources; coded patterns.	Triangulated quotes plus behavioral observation; counter-evidence acknowledged.
Per-customer math	Confused costs; no contribution margin.	CM computed but with errors; one price scenario.	Correct CM and breakeven; clear pricing rationale.	CM under multiple price scenarios; LTV-lite reasoning.
Honest messaging	Vague or misleading claims.	Some specifics; some unsupported claims.	All claims supported; clean ethics check.	A/B-tested copy with rationale; resists clever-but-borderline phrasing.
Feedback system	One-time check; no documentation.	Ad-hoc feedback; partial revisions.	1-week feedback loop with 3 documented changes.	Sustained loop plus signal-vs-noise analysis plus revision log.

CALIBRATION NOTE

Score honestly. A "3" means the student met the standard the way an adult professional would. A "4" means they did something a working entrepreneur would be proud to show. Withhold "4" unless the work earns it.

SENSITIVITY AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

What We Don't Ask. What We Always Frame.

Money is a tool, not a virtue. Some students live in households with credit-card debt, low or no banking access, or active financial stress. The curriculum is built so that none of those students is asked to disclose, perform, or apologize for their family situation.

Rules of the room

- **Never ask about family money.** No questions about parents income, debts, accounts, or banking status.
- **Use neutral hypotheticals.** "For a sample family with a $4,000/month take-home" — not "your family."
- **Decouple wealth from worth.** Cash never says "everyone can be rich." Cash says "you will be a clearer thinker about money no matter what you end up doing."
- **Name systemic factors honestly.** Wage gaps, geography, and luck shape outcomes. The skill we build is the skill in the student hands.
- **Protect the venture.** A student Capstone is theirs. We don't require they share revenue or family contribution. The artifact is the work, not the bank account.

Family engagement

Parents get one well-framed question per quarter — never a quiz, never a money-disclosure prompt. The default frame is curiosity ("What did you notice about your customers this week?"), not interrogation ("How much did you make?").

"Money is a tool. The question is not whether your family has a lot of it. The question is what you do with the moves we are practicing — interview, math, message, listen — wherever your starting line happens to be."

— CASH

ACTIVITY INDEX

Ten Activities. One Notebook.

Every activity in this book is built to be done with a pencil, your own evidence, and the questions Cash keeps asking. Skip nothing. Date everything. Re-read in three months.

No.	Activity	What you will do
01	Day 1 Customer Assumption	One sentence, one card. Don't try to be right; try to be specific.
02	Open vs. Leading Questions	Rewrite five leading questions into open ones. Practice on a partner.
03	Coding Patterns from Transcripts	Highlight surprises, frustrations, wishes. Tally them. Find the pattern.
04	Persona Pack v1	Combine evidence into one specific person — name, behaviors, top frustration.
05	Variable Cost per Unit	From a real receipt, compute the cost per one of the thing you sell.
06	Contribution Margin Worksheet	Price minus variable cost. Decide if it covers your fixed costs.
07	Two-Message A/B Test	Two honest messages. Three-day test. Report the winner and why.
08	Persuasion vs. Manipulation Line	Sort 10 ad claims onto a line. Defend your placement.
09	1-Week Feedback Loop	Collect, code, and act on feedback. Document three changes.
10	Final Capstone Defense	Five slides. Five minutes. Show the moves you made.

NOTEBOOK SETUP

Get a single notebook for the whole year. Number every page. The first 5 pages are your Vocabulary Spine. The last 5 pages are your Day-1 Assumptions (you will come back to those). Everything in between is your work.

Notebook checklist

- **Title page** — your name, your venture working-title, today's date.
- **Vocabulary spine** — 5 pages reserved for definitions you will add as we go.
-

Customer notes — one section for interview transcripts. Use direct quotes, with initials and dates.

- **Math section** — receipts taped in, per-unit computations, contribution margin scratch work.
- **Messaging section** — drafts of two-claim A/B tests, with what won and why.
- **Feedback log** — one page per week of your feedback system, with the three changes you made.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Worked Example: Per-Customer Math at the Snack Stand

Devon sells protein cookies after school. He sells 30 cookies a week at $2.00 each. Revenue is $60. He spends $0.85 on each cookie (oats, peanut butter, packaging). His variable cost per cookie is $0.85.

Contribution margin per cookie = $2.00 - $0.85 = **$1.15**. His fixed cost (the table he rents from the school store) is $20/week. He needs **$20 / $1.15 = 18 cookies/week** just to cover the table. He's currently selling 30. He's clearing $14.50/week after fixed costs.

Devon's question to Cash: should he raise the price to $2.50? Cash answers with a question: "Which people, and how do you know? Run a 3-day test. Half the kids see $2.00. Half see $2.50. Tell me what they actually buy."

WHAT TO COPY

The move here is not the answer. It is the structure: specific number, specific person, specific decision. Use that pattern in your own venture this quarter.

> *"Most adults skip this. You won't. Pick one customer. Compute one number. Decide one thing." — Cash*

END-OF-QUARTER REFLECTION

Four Quarters. Same Five Questions.

At the end of every quarter you will answer the same five questions. The answers should look different over time. Reread the previous quarter before you write a new one.

1. **Which people did you talk to this quarter, and what did they actually say?**

   Specific quotes, initials, dates. Resist the urge to summarize.
2. **What did you change in your venture because of evidence?**

   Name the change. Name the evidence that caused it.
3. **What is one number you know better now than three months ago?**

   Variable cost per unit. Contribution margin. Anything quantitative.
4. **What is a claim you made that you would take back?**

   Be honest. The claim does not have to be public. The honesty is the move.
5. **What would Cash ask you about all of this?**

   "Which people, and how do you know?" is always available. Find your own version.

"Reflection is not a feeling check-in. It is a memory tool. The you in three months wants to know what the you today learned. Write it down so future-you can use it."

— CASH

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move through this program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepreneurship — no matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We promise clarity.

"Customers are evidence, not assumptions."

— CASH, GRADE 7